

01

The business behind the tour.

A practical owner and developer handover, with the complete guide-training and business-plan appendix.

CURRENT STATUS: PRIVATE PLANNING PREVIEW

Branch A/B planning and review work. Ticket sales remain closed. Stripe credentials, meeting/contact details, final refund terms and the reviewed checkout-charge policy still need completion. Public access and the intended aisftour.com domain also need launch setup.

BUILDERS. BALLERS. & THE BAY.

A contemporary San Francisco tour on foot and by Muni. This packet connects the customer experience to the software, money, staffing and daily operating decisions behind it.

Inside this packet	Where to find it
System, endpoints and stored data	Backend page 2
Required settings and launch ownership	Backend page 3
Payments, taxes, holds and refunds	Backend page 4
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Guide training, routes A/B/C, ticket costs, fog and budget	Appendix: original pages 1-15

[Open the current review website](#) | [Open the GitHub repository](#)

The appendix retains its own page numbers. Proposed Branch C prices, duration and operating decisions remain proposals; the website does not sell Branch C. Financial scenarios are planning assumptions, not sales forecasts.

02

How the backend works.

The website runs on React/Vinext with Cloudflare Workers and a D1 database. Stripe-hosted Checkout handles payment entry.

CUSTOMER JOURNEY

Choose date + branch + guests + optional return → review the server-calculated price → acknowledge ages 16+ → Stripe Checkout → verified confirmation and calendar download. The payment stages activate only after setup is complete.

Endpoint	Purpose
GET /api/availability	Validates the date; reports sales readiness and places remaining when sales are enabled.
POST /api/checkout	Revalidates the offer, prices and charges; claims seats atomically; opens a Stripe session.
POST /api/stripe/webhook	Verifies signed payment, expiry and refund events and updates booking status.
GET /api/receipt	Retrieves the Stripe session and verifies the stored booking before showing a confirmation.
GET /api/giants	Provides the Giants schedule. Warriors and Valkyries use official external schedule links.

WHAT IS STORED

D1 stores the booking ID, tour date, A/B branch, guest count, return selection, USD total in cents, original price/charge snapshot, status, created time, age acknowledgement, Stripe session and payment references. A separate full-refund record preserves refunds that arrive before a completion event.

Card details remain with Stripe. The current site has no operator dashboard, automated customer-email service, guide roster export, Branch C booking engine or customer self-service cancellation flow. Those are separate future capabilities.

03

Settings before ticket sales.

Only `BOOKING_ENABLED=false` and `SITE_URL` were configured in the hosted environment at the latest check. No secrets are printed in this document.

Setting / item	Current state	Owner action
<code>BOOKING_ENABLED</code>	false	Keep closed until the remaining items and test-mode workflow pass.
<code>SITE_URL</code>	Review origin set	Use the approved HTTPS origin; update when the public domain is connected.
<code>STRIPE_SECRET_KEY</code>	Missing	Enter a test key securely in hosted settings first; use a live key only after acceptance.
<code>STRIPE_WEBHOOK_SECRET</code>	Missing	Use the signing secret for this exact Stripe endpoint and environment.
<code>MEETING_POINT</code>	Missing	Confirm the permitted street-level Wharf meeting point and publish it in the FAQ.
<code>CONTACT_EMAIL</code>	Missing	Choose a monitored booking and support address.
<code>CANCELLATION_POLICY</code>	Missing	Finalize clear refund/change terms and mirror them on the website.
Charge policy	Unreviewed	Record applicable taxes/transaction fees, then update <code>lib/charge-policy.mjs</code> .

ACCESS AND DELIVERY

The Site is owner-private. Stripe cannot deliver a webhook through a private sign-in page. Use an approved, externally reachable test environment or approve public access while bookings stay disabled. Verify delivery to `SITE_URL/api/stripe/webhook` before opening sales.

GitHub stores the source on main; a GitHub push alone does not update the hosted Site. Deployment requires a successful build, a saved Site version and a successful publish result. Domain ownership and DNS for `aisftour.com` have not been verified.

04

Money, seats and refunds.

Use the stored booking and Stripe evidence as the source of truth for payments and seat release.

Rule	Current implementation
Prices	\$195 per adult per A/B departure; optional guided return +\$40 per person. Two adults with return = \$470 before any verified government charges.
Capacity / booking window	8 guests; Tuesday-Sunday; at least 1 hour before departure; at most 180 days ahead. Every guest must be 16+.
Seat holds	Atomic claim prevents overselling. Checkout sessions expire after 35 minutes. Leaving the payment page does not immediately release a hold.
Payment confirmation	Checks paid status, USD, booking identity and the exact original amount and charge breakdown. A success-page visit alone is insufficient.
Full / partial refunds	Process refunds in Stripe. A signed full-refund event releases seats. Partial refunds do not automatically release seats.
Recovery	On availability/checkout requests, holds older than 40 minutes are checked against Stripe. Incomplete provider evidence keeps the hold.

SAN FRANCISCO TAXES AND FEES

This is a guide service with guest-purchased transit and admissions. Confirm the actual tax classification before applying a retail sales-tax rate. CDTFA guidance supports reviewing qualifying tour services as services; it is not an account-specific tax determination. Mandatory operator fees belong in advertised prices. Only verified government charges on the transaction should be added separately. [3, 4]

The code uses configured manual Stripe tax rates, not automatic Stripe Tax classification. Rate and total mismatches block checkout. If no extra charges apply, record that conclusion and use a reviewed empty policy. Collection does not itself handle registration or remittance. [2]

05

Run the day well.

Keep guest service, staff time and revenue records connected, even before a dedicated operator dashboard is built.

When	Operator / guide routine
Before each operating day	Check paid departures and guest quantities against Stripe and booking records. Verify Muni service, weather, meeting access and stadium events. Resolve support requests.
Before each departure	Confirm the roster, ages/access needs and optional returns. Count the group. Teach guests to choose and buy their own Muni fare; confirm everyone can board.
During the route	Follow the timed trial route, use exterior company storytelling, record changes and keep the group together. Recheck transit before transfers.
At the finish	Deliver the optional guided return after the tour. Help other guests plan onward travel. Note actual hours, costs, incidents and guest feedback.
After the day	Reconcile paid, held, expired and refunded records. Review failed Stripe deliveries and support cases. Keep a dated operating and finance log.

STAFFING AND WAGES

The general San Francisco minimum wage is **\$19.61/hour from July 1, 2026**. The workbook uses a **\$40/hour owner-guide allowance**, including preparation, returns, administration and rehearsals. Recheck the legal floor before hiring or changing the budget. [5]

The base model allows 267 owner hours/month (\$10,680). It is an economic allowance, not a complete employee payroll. Add applicable overtime, employer payroll costs, paid leave and workers' compensation when staffing with employees. The detailed assumptions and limits are in appendix pages 10-11.

BRANCH C

Run only as a separately announced, sunny and fog-free west-side outing. The revised coffee-inclusive pilot starts near Judah/La Playa and visits Outerlands on weekends before taking N Judah east. Use appendix pages 5-6 for timing, venue conditions and fog planning. Public dates, price and garden terms still need finalization.

06

Motion and phone operations.

Real animated image files preserve the fine pixel identity while keeping the booking controls calm and readable.

THE FOUR ANIMATED PHOTOGRAPHS

California Street, Chinatown, Chase Center and Ocean Beach use looping GIF exports of the existing photo shader. The images keep the ink/lime treatment and recognizable real locations. Matching still frames support pause and reduced-motion preferences. GIF files and source/license notes are also supplied as a separate reusable asset pack.

Behavior	Operating expectation
Autoplay	A loop plays when its image is on screen and the tab is active. Images farther down the page load as needed.
Pause / reduced motion	The pause control shows a matching still. A browser reduced-motion preference uses still imagery.
Slow connection / failed asset	A still remains available while an animation loads or if it fails. Keep the files small and preserve the original photo credits.
Phone navigation	Routes, Book, Muni and More are reachable in the bottom bar. Branch selection preserves the staged date, guests and return.
Home-screen / offline	Installation instructions are in More. Only the static city guide is cached offline; booking, receipts and live schedules need a connection.

MAINTENANCE

Keep GIFs and matching posters in the site assets, retain the same per-image Creative Commons licenses, and review motion on a phone after any replacement. Build and publish the whole validated version. Recheck pause, small screens and the booking flow after visual edits.

A standard PDF shows still pages. Open the linked website or the supplied .gif files to see motion. Do not place backend credentials or private booking records in downloadable public assets.

07

Release checks and references.

Use this page as the handover checklist; it distinguishes implemented behavior from launch work still to be done.

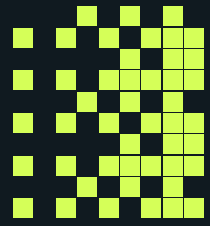
Already verified	Still required before sales
26 automated tests cover pricing, charges, capacity, signatures, schema, refunds, recovery and offline behavior.	Stripe test-mode success/decline, expiry, refund and real signed webhook delivery.
Browser checks: A/B switching, guests, \$40 return, review, phone date updates and Monday rejection.	Final meeting point, customer contact, refund terms, route/accessibility trial and operating permissions.
Phone menu and responsive review widths; \$470 review for two guests with return.	Reviewed charge classification; actual Stripe totals/rounding; approved public access and domain setup.

Stop-sales response: set `BOOKING_ENABLED=false` and publish the updated environment if checkout totals, webhook delivery or inventory reconciliation cannot be trusted. Review existing orders before changing or releasing seats. Monitor `checkout_start_failed`, `stripe_webhook_processing_failed` and `booking_reconciliation_deferred`.

SOURCE REFERENCES

- [1. Stripe - verify webhook signatures](#)
- [2. Stripe - configured tax rates](#)
- [3. CDTFA - destination management companies](#)
- [4. California Attorney General - advertised prices and fees](#)
- [5. San Francisco - historical minimum wage rates](#)
- [6. AI SF Tour source, operations and tests](#)
- [7. Current review website](#)

Reviewed against the project source and hosted setup on September 9, 2026. No Stripe account credentials were available for a real payment test. The appendix contains the full guide-training, route, fog-season and business-plan references.



BUILDERS. BALLERS. & THE BAY.

GUIDE TRAINING + BUSINESS PLAN

We teach you how to enjoy the city
the way the locals do.

A

Old soul. New intelligence.

B

Builders. Ballers. & the Bay.

C

When the fog takes a day off.



02

The offer and ticket costs

Prices are USD per guest. A and B are separate purchases; this is the working launch offer.

Product	Guest price	Operating promise
Branch A	\$195	8:30 AM-12:00 PM. Old city, transit and AI.
Branch B	\$195	2:00-5:30 PM. Dogpatch, builders and the waterfront.
Branch C	\$195 proposed	Separate 4.5-hour sunny-day pilot. Price, dates and duration need operator approval.
Guided Wharf return	+\$40	A/B only. Guide time after the tour; around 45 extra minutes. Transit fare is separate.
Muni-only day pass	\$5.70	Purchased by the guest when needed. Buses, historic streetcars and light rail. [1]
Muni single ride	\$2.85 digital/card \$3 cash	120 minutes including transfers; select an appropriate fare for the whole outing. [2]
Muni, ages 16-18	\$0	Regular Muni is free for ages 18 and under; the \$195 tour ticket still applies. [3]
Japanese Tea Garden	Live rate at booking	Paid separately. Carry a \$25 planning allowance per paying visitor; this is not a verified ticket quote. [4]

Adult examples: A or B plus a \$5.70 pass = **\$200.70**. With the optional guided return = **\$240.70**.
Proposed C plus the pass and \$25 garden allowance = **\$225.70**, subject to actual garden pricing.

Included: guiding, neighborhood interpretation and practical Muni instruction. **Separate:** transit fares, coffee, meals, tea, shopping, garden entry, game tickets and gratuities. Coffee is extra to the examples above. Company offices, stadium interiors and Alcatraz admission are not part of these routes.

A/B operate Tuesday-Sunday; no Mondays. Ages 16+. Initial capacity: 8 guests. Confirm access needs and under-18 arrangements before sale. Branch C remains a proposal and is not currently bookable.



03

Branch A | Old soul. New intelligence.

8:30 AM-12:00 PM / 210 minutes / Fisherman's Wharf to Ferry Building area.

Time	Where / guide action
8:30-8:40	Fisherman's Wharf. Welcome, headcount and pass check. Brief Alcatraz view story when visible.
8:40-9:05	Walk to North Beach. Use the Taylor/Columbus approach to Washington Square; allow for crossings.
9:05-9:20	North Beach. Italian community, cafes and the places where people exchange ideas.
9:20-9:35	Walk to Chinatown. Continue to Stockton/Washington at the group's pace.
9:35-9:55	Chinatown-Rose Pak. Community, civic advocacy and station art. Practice choosing the train direction.
9:55-10:20	T Third southbound to Yerba Buena/Moscone. Include station entry, wait, ride and exit. [5]
10:20-10:30	Moscone area. Steve Jobs, the 2007 iPhone debut and the changing way people use computers.
10:30-10:50	Walk along Howard. Continue toward First/Howard on public sidewalks.
10:50-11:10	Anthropic corridor. Exterior interpretation around 500 Howard; discuss Claude and evaluating AI answers.
11:10-11:25	Comfort break. Use a prechecked restroom; refreshments are an optional guest purchase.
11:25-11:45	Walk to the Ferry Building. Connect the city's older networks with its newer ones.
11:45-12:00	Buffer and close. Questions, onward trip planning and return-service headcount.

Time budget: 80 minutes walking + 25 transit + 75 interpretation + 15 break + 15 buffer. These are rehearsal allowances, not measured group timings. Select exact meeting, standing and restroom locations in the field.

If delayed: shorten the closing discussion; do not rush a crossing. Optional return: F streetcar toward the Wharf from the Ferry Building, then walk from Jefferson/Taylor. Allow about 25-40 minutes, subject to service. [6]



04

Branch B | Builders. Ballers. & the Bay.

2:00-5:30 PM / 210 minutes / Fisherman's Wharf to Oracle Park area.

Time	Where / guide action
2:00-2:05	Fisherman's Wharf. Welcome and start the Muni lesson; complete the fare check before boarding.
2:05-3:05	Wharf to Dogpatch. Walk to Columbus/Bay; 30 inbound to Stockton/Washington, then T Third southbound to Third/20th. Include walks, waits, station access and teaching. [5,7]
3:05-3:15	Walk to RH San Francisco. From Third/20th toward 590 20th Street. Corgi Cafe remains a neighborhood story, not a second scheduled coffee stop.
3:15-3:35	Restoration Hardware / The Palm Court. Coffee in the historic Bethlehem Steel gallery. Guest-paid; preconfirm coffee-only service, group access, timing and restrooms. [14a]
3:35-3:50	Pier 70 / Y Combinator neighborhood. A short public-street story of making, funding and testing new ideas.
3:50-4:15	Walk to Chase Center. About 15 minutes walking and 10 minutes on the Warriors, Valkyries and changing waterfront. Check home-game schedules. [15a,15b]
4:15-4:40	OpenAI exterior. Recheck the proposed Third Street frontage. Explain generative AI, its limitations and the computing behind it.
4:40-5:05	Walk toward Oracle Park. Check event barriers and select the safe approach before arrival.
5:05-5:15	Oracle Park exterior. Giants, the Bay and options for the evening. Show the actual date's schedule.
5:15-5:30	Buffer and close. Preserve time for late transit, questions and onward directions.

KEEP THE PROMISES PRECISE

AI stops are exterior stories; the RH coffee visit depends on service capacity. Confirm a 20-minute coffee-only stop with RH before offering it. Do not promise seating, rooftop access, free drinks or a full meal. If unavailable, announce the replacement break before departure. [12-15]

If more than 15 minutes behind: reduce the Pier 70 loop to a short street-side story and shorten the cafe stop. Optional return: walk to a current 30 outbound stop around Townsend/Lusk or Third/Brannan, then alight near Columbus/North Point. Allow 40-55 minutes; event traffic can add time. [7]

Guests staying for a game skip the immediate return; a later escort needs separate booking and staffing.



05

Branch C | When the fog takes a day off.

Proposed pilot: 11:00 AM-3:30 PM / 270 minutes / Ocean Beach to Japantown.

A SEPARATE OUTING - ONLY ON A PERFECTLY SUNNY DAY

Ocean Beach, Outerlands coffee, the Japanese Tea Garden, Haight-Ashbury and Japantown sit outside A/B. This coffee-inclusive pilot is for sunny weekends. Confirm sun and no fog at the beach. South Bay places remain stories, never visits.

Time	Proposed west-to-east sequence
11:00-11:30	Ocean Beach, Judah/La Playa area. Meet at an agreed landward point; 20 minutes for surf culture and Muni, then allow 10 minutes walking toward 45th/Judah.
11:30-11:50	Outerlands, 4001 Judah Street. Guest-paid coffee. Current daytime brunch: Sat-Sun 9:30 AM-2 PM, walk-ins only, maximum seated party 8. Preconfirm quick service. [14b]
11:50-12:35	N Judah to the Tea Garden. Walk to Judah/46th, ride inbound to Judah/9th, then walk into the park. Includes wait, ride and approach; verify service. [8]
12:35-1:10	Japanese Tea Garden. Entry, a brief garden visit and restrooms. Admission and optional tea are extra; no sit-down tea service is promised. [4]
1:10-1:50	Walk through the park to Haight-Ashbury. Rehearse the accessible route and allow a steady pace.
1:50-2:10	Haight-Ashbury. Counterculture and creative communities; keep shop entrances clear.
2:10-3:00	To Japantown. 7 inbound toward Haight/Fillmore; transfer to 22 inbound/northbound toward Fillmore/Geary, then walk. Includes waiting and buffer. [9]
3:00-3:30	Japantown. Neighborhood orientation, questions and close. Optional food, tea or shopping after the tour.

Coffee logistics: 8 guests plus a guide exceed Outerlands' seated-party limit. Confirm takeaway service or an acceptable arrangement; do not assume seating. Skip a long queue. Announce any weekday coffee substitution before booking. Drinks are extra. [14b]

Pilot: \$195 proposed, 4-8 guests; fares and garden entry extra. Rehearse all 270 minutes and the Judah meeting point; no Wharf return. Use another guide or close conflicting A/B departures. Confirm garden and NPS authorization before sale. [10]



06

Fog: plan the season, check the beach.

A qualitative operating calendar for Ocean Beach; not measured monthly probabilities or a forecast.

MOST FOG-PRONE: LATE SPRING AND SUMMER
For planning, treat May-August as the fog-sensitive window, especially June-August. NPS identifies September and October as Ocean Beach's sunniest months. A sunny downtown forecast does not establish clear conditions at the beach. [11]

JAN Rain season	FEB Rain season	MAR Transition	APR Fog builds	MAY Fog-sensitive	JUN Fog-sensitive
JUL Fog-sensitive	AUG Fog-sensitive	SEP Best window	OCT Best window	NOV Rain season	DEC Rain season

Month labels translate NPS's broad seasonal guidance into a planning calendar. Fog and wind can occur in every month. November-March is generally the rainy season; clearer coastal months are not guarantees of safe or comfortable conditions. [11]

PROPOSED C DECISION ROUTINE

- The evening before:** review the NWS coastal forecast, alerts and expected cloud/fog timing. Flag a conditional departure and prepare the agreed guest message. Do not rely on a generic city weather icon.
- By 9:00 AM for an 11:00 AM start:** the operator makes the proposed go/no-go decision using a recent beach observation, local forecast and operational conditions. Recheck on site before guests arrive. The 9:00 AM deadline is a proposed service policy to approve before sale.
- If the sunny condition fails:** use the published cancellation policy. Recommended launch policy: offer a full refund or a guest-selected reschedule when the operator cancels before departure. Never substitute A or B without the guest's agreement.
- If fog arrives en route:** the guide can leave the shore for the agreed inland route when safe; otherwise end or reroute according to the disclosed policy. Record actual conditions and how much of the outing was delivered. Do not promise uninterrupted sunshine.



07

Teach Muni, then let guests lead.

The public promise is local know-how. This practical lesson is delivered in person.

OPENING SCRIPT

“We teach you how to enjoy the city the way the locals do. Your transit fare is separate. Let's check what you already have, choose the right option, and practice together before our first ride.”

Step	Demonstrate and check
1 / Choose	Ask about existing passes, youth eligibility and phone access. Explain that a Muni-only day pass covers regular buses, historic streetcars and light rail until 11:59 PM that day; it is not a rolling 24-hour pass. Cable cars, BART and Caltrain are separate. [1,3]
2 / Tap	For a pass on Clipper, use the same card or device at each boarding or Metro faregate. Wait for acceptance. Muni does not require tapping out. [2,16]
3 / Activate	For MuniMobile, activate the pass before boarding or entering the paid area. Show the live active ticket; it is not tapped on a Clipper reader. At stations, follow the agent's gate direction. [17]
4 / Paper	For a cash farebox day pass, tell the operator which product is wanted before inserting exact cash. Keep the paper pass for inspection and show it as directed at Metro entry. [1,16]
5 / Ride	Check route and destination; let others off. Valid-pass holders may use any door; cash purchases use the front. Keep aisles and priority seating clear, request the stop where needed and retain proof of payment. [16]
6 / Transfer	Have a guest identify the next route, direction and stop, and say whether their fare is tapped or shown. Confirm it before moving the group.

THE FINISH-LINE CHECK

Each guest should be able to explain their next boarding action, the fare's expiry and a route to the next place they want to visit. Help guests retain independent access to their tickets when the group separates.

App transition: SFMTA plans to stop MuniMobile day-pass sales January 3, 2027. Recheck current guidance before tours; single-ride app sales ended September 1, 2026. Carry instructions for a workable cash/paper or Clipper alternative. [18]



08

Tell a story the city can support.

Use a visible place, one verified fact, a human question and a connection to today.

Stop / theme	Guide prompt and factual boundary
Wharf / Alcatraz	Point toward the island when visible. The 1962 escape plot used decoy heads with human hair. Ask how an observer decides what to trust. Do not claim the escapees' ultimate fate is established. [19]
North Beach / Chinatown	Treat both as living neighborhoods. Discuss gathering places, migration and civic voice. At Rose Pak Station, connect community advocacy with practical transit access; avoid caricatures or partisan verdicts. [20]
Moscone / Steve Jobs	Apple introduced iPhone at Macworld San Francisco on January 9, 2007. Ask how interfaces change habits. South Bay homes and company campuses are stories only; no residential stop or private address is needed. [21]
Anthropic / AI judgment	Explain that Claude is an AI assistant and use a harmless example of an answer that needs checking. Company occupancy changes: recheck frontage and keep all interpretation on appropriate public space. [12]
Dogpatch / Y Combinator	Connect the district's industrial past with today's startup activity. Explain an accelerator as a program helping young companies develop, with funding and advice. YC identifies its campus at Pier 70; no access is promised. [13]
OpenAI / chips	Explain generative AI in everyday terms: useful outputs can still be wrong. AMD and NVIDIA support a story about computing hardware, not a South Bay detour or investment recommendation.
Chase / Oracle	Connect local identity and waterfront change. Show the official Warriors , Valkyries and Giants schedules for the chosen date. Check home games at Chase Center or Oracle Park. Game tickets are separate from the tour. [15,15a,15b]
Ocean Beach / west side	Wetsuits, not board shorts. Discuss surf culture from the shore. Distinguish the Tea Garden in Golden Gate Park from Japantown, a separate neighborhood. Haight-Ashbury adds the counterculture thread.

Delivery drill: give a 90-second stop talk, then answer one question in plain language. If a fact is uncertain, say so and check later. Keep the tour independent: no company sponsorship, staff meeting or special access is implied.



09

Run a calm, well-paced group.

Training is complete when the guide can lead the route and recover from a realistic disruption.

BEFORE EACH DEPARTURE

Review the guest list, ages, access needs, return buyers and current payment/booking status. Check Muni alerts, weather, stadium events, company frontages and comfort stops. Carry charged phone, power bank, route notes, first-aid supplies appropriate to your training, and the operator's contact procedure.

Arrive about 30 minutes early. Position the sign only in the agreed location. Check guests in, confirm the booked branch, explain walking/public-transit demands and identify a reunion point if separated. Confirm that every guest can use the chosen fare.

ON THE ROUTE

Headcount before boarding, after alighting and after every comfort stop. Gather on the same side of the crossing before speaking. Let a full vehicle leave rather than forcing the group aboard. If split, use the pre-agreed reunion stop and phone procedure; nobody follows a moving vehicle.

Keep the group out of business doorways and residential entrances. Ask before photographing people. Allow rest and restroom needs without shaming a guest. Use the field-tested accessible alternative when a stair, slope or broken elevator prevents the planned route.

INCIDENTS AND WEATHER

For an immediate emergency, call 911, give the exact location and follow dispatcher instructions. Keep the rest of the group in a safe place; provide only assistance within your training. At Ocean Beach, stay on the landward route and do not offer water entry, surf or swim instruction. Record incidents factually afterward.

Guide assessment	Pass evidence
Route rehearsal	Completes the route safely; records walking, waiting, breaks and buffer time.
Teaching practice	A new guest can choose, use and explain their fare, then plan one onward ride.
Disruption drill	Handles a missed vehicle, closed restroom, separated guest and failed sunny-day condition.
Story accuracy	Uses dated sources; clearly distinguishes a verified fact, personal interpretation and uncertainty.
Owner sign-off	Confirms competence in each area before solo guiding.



10

The A/B operating budget

Current workbook basis: \$195 tickets, \$40 return, guest-paid fares and one owner-guide.

Average month	Conservative	Base	High
Seat occupancy	25%	50%	75%
Paid guests	104	208	312
Tour + return sales	\$21,320	\$42,640	\$63,960
Operating surplus*	\$7,917.92	\$27,733.04	\$47,548.16

*Planning scenarios, not demand forecasts. All 52 monthly A/B departures are costed. The model uses 8 seats per departure, 2 departures/day, 6 days/week and 52/12 weeks/month. Return take-up is assumed to be 25%.

Base monthly cost	Amount	Basis
Owner tour / return / admin labor	\$10,680	267 hours at \$40/hour, above the \$19.61 SF minimum; includes 39 return hours.
Card processing	\$1,314.56	Domestic online baseline; one guest/order plus a conservative separate return transaction. [22]
Refund / incident reserve	\$1,279.20	3% of gross sales as a planning deduction.
Guest consumables	\$416.00	\$2 per guest; guest Muni fares cost the operator \$0.
Guide Muni	\$148.20	26 operating days x \$5.70.
Other overhead	\$1,069.00	Insurance, web/tools, data, bookkeeping, marketing and equipment/admin reserves.
Total modeled operating cost	\$14,906.96	Leaves \$27,733.04 before tax and unmodeled costs.

Funding: \$4,634.50 startup including 15% contingency, plus \$23,794.40 for two months of committed costs = **\$28,428.90**. Full-schedule break-even is about **63 paid guests/month** at the modeled mix. Owner labor is an economic cost even when paid as drawings.

Limits: supplier prices, insurance, permissions, tax treatment, occupancy and acquisition are unvalidated. Employee overtime and employer payroll costs, income tax, sales-tax effects, financing and OTA commissions are excluded. Branch C is excluded. Pilot before scaling to 267 owner hours/month.



11

Budget for every hour worked.

San Francisco minimum wage and the owner-guide labor allowance. Verified September 9, 2026.

SF MINIMUM WAGE: \$19.61 PER HOUR

Effective **July 1, 2026**, the general San Francisco minimum wage is **\$19.61/hour**. The workbook retains a **\$40/hour** owner-guide target, \$20.39 above that floor. Its effective budget rate is the higher of the target and the minimum wage.

Time allowance	Current budget treatment
Branch A or B	3.5 hours with guests + 0.5 hour preparation/close = 4 hours per departure.
Guided return	0.75 hour extra per departure; 39 hours/month reserved when returns are offered.
Administration	20 hours/month for bookings, marketing, customer service and maintenance.
Startup rehearsals	12 hours at the same effective hourly rate; included in startup costs.
Proposed Branch C	4.5 hours on route + 1 hour preparation/close = 5.5 hours; separate from the A/B monthly model.

The base A/B budget still allows **267 owner hours and \$10,680/month**. That is an economic allowance for owner time, not a complete employee payroll estimate. Record actual hours: required setup, training, work travel and close-out may exceed these planning allowances.

BEFORE HIRING GUIDES

Budget applicable overtime and employer payroll costs, including payroll taxes, paid leave and workers' compensation. For covered nonexempt California employees, overtime generally starts above 8 hours/day or 40 hours/week; double-time and seventh-day rules can also apply. The full owner schedule averages about 61.6 hours/week, so staffing it with one employee needs an overtime calculation.

Keep the floor current: update Assumptions C65 after checking the city's published rate, especially before each July 1. C66 applies the higher rate to A/B tour, return, admin and startup rehearsal labor. Reprice the separate C pilot when labor changes. Missing or invalid rates display an error.

Sources: [SF minimum wage history](#) | [California overtime rules](#) | [Hours worked](#).



12

Return economics and a Branch C pilot

Use small experiments before committing the full schedule or counting sunny-day revenue.

THE \$40 GUIDED RETURN

At \$40/hour, a 45-minute return costs \$30 in guide labor. Each \$40 buyer contributes about **\$37.34** after modeled card fees and the 3% reserve. One buyer covers marginal guide time. At 25% take-up, the full-schedule model leaves \$381.68/month after reserving return time for every departure.

BRANCH C - PROPOSED STANDALONE ECONOMICS

Model \$195 per guest, 4-8 guests and 4.5 hours on route plus 1 hour of preparation/close. Guests pay transit and garden admission. These are planning assumptions, not an approved public offer.

Per C departure / 4 guests	Planning amount
Gross ticket sales	4 x \$195 = \$780.00
Guide labor	5.5 hours x \$40 = \$220.00
Guide transit + garden allowance	\$5.70 + \$25.00 = \$30.70
Guest consumables + card fees + reserve	\$8.00 + \$23.82 + \$23.40 = \$55.22
Annual NPS authorization allocated to 16 runs	\$650 / 16 = \$40.63 per run (rounded). [10]
Contribution before shared overhead / acquisition	\$433.46 per completed departure (unrounded basis).

The current GGNRA guided-services schedule lists \$350 annual application + \$300 per guide for a placard. Confirm the exact authorization and insurance conditions with NPS; allow its published processing time. Additional garden/group permissions and fees may apply. The \$25 garden figure is an unverified allowance, not a quoted rate. [4,10]

C is a conditional pilot, not revenue added to the existing full A/B model. A second guide is needed for simultaneous operation. If the owner leads C instead, remove conflicting A/B departures and their revenue. Fewer than 16 C runs increase authorization cost per completed outing.

MEASURE THE PILOT

Track inquiries, paid guests, costs, guide hours and sales source. Record C weather cancellations separately. Use the pilot to settle the proposed four-guest minimum and refund policy.



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The business plan forward

Positioning: a contemporary SF city tour with AI, neighborhoods, sports and practical local travel skills.

Stage	Work and release evidence
Before any paid tour	Confirm exact meeting/finish points, route timing, accessible alternatives and restrooms. Arrange insurance, business registration and location permissions. Set capacity, cancellations, weather terms and under-18 procedures. [10,23,24]
Days 1-14 after essentials	Rehearse A and B at the actual departure times on a weekday and weekend. Run a small pilot and debrief every outing. Prepare one short story card per stop and pass each guide's observed assessment.
Days 15-30	Open limited A/B dates only after checkout and operating terms work. Test Wharf sign conversations, a hotel/concierge information sheet and direct online bookings. Record acquisition cost and hours spent selling.
Days 31-60	Compare guest feedback with actual pace and margins. Change weak stops, refine check-in/return logistics and train backup coverage. Expand only the departure slots that show demand.
Days 61-90	Review cash, owner hours and repeatable bookings. Pilot C on selected clear days, prioritizing September/October opportunities when appropriate. Do not sell a daily sunny-beach promise.

CUSTOMER AND SALES APPROACH

Start with visitors who want to get beyond the Wharf and understand contemporary San Francisco. Lead with the neighborhood experience and local confidence; AI expertise is not required. For conference visitors, make the company-exterior scope explicit. For sports fans, show the real game schedule and separate admission.

Suggested street introduction: “Want to see the San Francisco people are building now? We explore on foot and by Muni, and show you how to keep enjoying the city like a local. Morning or afternoon?” Let the guest decide; keep the pedestrian path open.

WEBSITE RELEASE

The review website exists, but bookings remain disabled. Connect and verify aisftour.com, publish contact/meeting/cancellation information, configure Stripe and test checkout, confirmations, capacity and refunds. Release the public site before using the street QR. On September 8, 2026, aisftour.com did not resolve in a DNS check.



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Put the guide beside a clear sign.

Final advertisement artwork is supplied in two formats; placement and website readiness remain operating tasks.

Supplied format	Production instruction
18 x 24-inch portable sign	Use the 18 x 24 trim size for a compatible outdoor A-frame; print two panels for two-sided use. It is the compact option for the existing bike/trailer concept.
24 x 72-inch banner	Use the 24 x 72 trim size for an approved, sheltered freestanding display. Ask the supplier for an outdoor-rated system; do not assume an indoor retractable stand suits Wharf wind.
Both PDFs	Vector type and QR, embedded fonts, 0.125-inch bleed each edge and a defined TrimBox. Print at 100% of the trim size. Preserve the white QR quiet zone; never cover it with a logo.
Color and material	Ink #101a20, acid lime #d5ff58, cool white #f4f6f2. Use a matte finish; request a physical color proof and printer-specific color conversion. Bright lime varies by stock and process.
QR destination	https://aisftour.com - intended public website. Verify DNS, HTTPS, anonymous access, tour dates and the booking path before putting the advertisement outside.

STREET SETUP AND STORAGE

Agree the exact standing/display location with its property owner or responsible authority. The city's published A-frame order limits placement to business frontage and requires pedestrian clearances; it is not blanket permission for a roaming guide to place a sign anywhere at the Wharf. Confirm Port or park jurisdiction where relevant. [23,24]

Keep the display attended and out of curb ramps, queues and doorways. Use manufacturer-approved ballast and remove it when conditions exceed the equipment guidance or the sign moves. Arrange secure storage or collection before guiding; do not take a large sign upright on the bicycle.

PRODUCTION ALLOWANCE

The existing compact sign kit carries a **\$750 planning allowance**: panels \$120, A-frame \$180, cargo trailer \$350, sleeve/straps \$60 and ballast \$40. This is not a supplier quote. Tall-banner hardware/printing is an optional separate purchase and is not included in that allowance.

Release check: scan a full-size printed sample with more than one phone; open the destination without a staff login; confirm correct prices, meeting details and checkout. The final artwork removes the earlier DESIGN PROOF wording. It does not establish site access or authorize sidewalk placement.



Sources and operating references

Official sources checked or carried forward from September 8-9, 2026 research. Links are clickable.

1. [SFMTA / Muni-only day pass](#)
2. [SFMTA / Adult single ride](#)
3. [SFMTA / Free Muni for youth](#)
4. [Gardens of Golden Gate Park / Tickets and eligibility](#)
5. [SFMTA / T Third Street](#)
6. [SFMTA / F Market & Wharves](#)
7. [SFMTA / 30 Stockton](#)
8. [SFMTA / N Judah and current stops](#)
9. [SFMTA / 7 Haight-Noriega](#)
- 9a. [SFMTA / 22 Fillmore](#)
10. [NPS / GGNRA commercial use authorizations and fees](#)
11. [NPS / Ocean Beach seasonal weather](#)
- 11a. [NPS / San Francisco Maritime weather and microclimates](#)
12. [DivcoWest / Anthropoc Howard Street lease and occupancy](#)
13. [Y Combinator / Pier 70 campus description](#)
14. [Corgi Cafe / Locations](#)
- 14a. [RH / The Palm Court at 590 20th Street](#)
- 14b. [Outerlands / 4001 Judah, hours and brunch policy](#)
15. [MLB / Giants schedule](#)
- 15a. [Golden State Warriors / Schedule](#)
- 15b. [Golden State Valkyries / Schedule](#)
16. [SFMTA / How to ride Muni](#)
17. [SFMTA / MuniMobile instructions](#)
18. [SFMTA / MuniMobile transition](#)
19. [FBI / 1962 Alcatraz decoy heads](#)
20. [SFMTA / Chinatown-Rose Pak Station](#)
21. [Apple / iPhone introduction, January 9, 2007](#)
22. [Stripe / US pricing](#)
23. [SF Public Works / A-frame placement order](#)
24. [Port of San Francisco / Special events and site coordination](#)

Financial source: AI-SF-Tour-Budget.xlsx, updated September 9, 2026 with the SF minimum wage floor. Training times, C pricing, the \$25 garden allowance, the C decision deadline and pilot targets are planning proposals. Garden ticket prices depend on the visit; a reliable current general-admission price was not exposed in the official pages read.